Assignment 3: Report

Note: Assignment 3 is designed to include elements of peer feedback and takes place over several weeks. First you will be asked to submit a draft of part of your report, then you will provide peer-review for a number (3-5) of your fellow students, then you will submit the final complete version of your report. To complete the assignment successfully, it is crucial that you meet the deadlines for each part as outlined below.

See the Assessments page of the Stream site for the submission dates for each element of this assignment.

Assignment outline

One of the goals of Massey University is to be carbon neutral by 2030. This goal is articulated in the Massey Climate Action Plan 2021-2030. Zero carbon goals, such as Massey's, are linked to the UN Sustainable Development Goals as they respond to policies at the national scale aimed at reducing green-house gas emissions.

You will write a technical report that investigates one of the four emissions categories discussed in the Climate Action Plan. This report with provide a brief introduction to the climate action plan generally, and your chosen topic area specifically. It will summarise the findings of at least three scientific articles that are relevant to your topic. The contribution that Mātauranga Māori can make to actions related to your topic will be explored. Based on the information you discuss, you will make one or more recommendations for actions that could help the University realise it's emissions targets more efficiently.

As this will be a formal report, with the intended audience being the Massey senior leadership team, formal scientific writing conventions will be expected. All information sources should be properly cited and referenced. Your report should be structured with clear sections and headings. The information in your report should be communicated using appropriate language for a formal setting. Figures and tables should be used in suitable way to support the report.

In addition to the elements discussed above, you will also need to provide a brief statement reflecting on your experience of the process of peer-review for this assignment.

Overall Assignment 3 components

A/ Choose one of the following areas of focus from the Massey Climate Action Plan:

- Buildings and Energy
- Transport
- Farms
- Waste

B/ Research your chosen topic to find sources that provide information that can be used to support recommendations for Massey.

C/ Write a report (1500 +/- 150 words) which includes the following:

- a discussion of the sustainability challenges relevant to your chosen focus area and how this issue is of importance to Massey
- summarised information from relevant sources that provides evidence to support recommendation/s
- consideration of cultural components of the focus area, such as discussion of relevant Mātauranga Māori concepts (e.g. whakapapa, mana, mauri and kaitiakitanga)
- recommendation/s for how Massey can achieve, or continue to achieve, sustainability targets relevant to the focus area
- the report must refer to at least three peer-reviewed, primary scientific articles that explain how science can respond to the sustainability challenges identified
- diagrams (graphs and/or tables) from key references or generated from current Massey data
- appropriate structure and language for a technical report
- in-text citations for all source information
- a reference list recording all the sources you have used in the report, formatted according to APA conventions (not included in the 1500 word limit)
- in addition to the report, include a brief statement (around 100 words) identifying any changes you made to your final report as a result of the peer feedback exercise (not included in the 1500 word limit)

Breakdown of Assignment 3 tasks

Part 1 – Submission of draft for peer review

Using the Workshop tool for Assignment 3 on Stream, submit an excerpt from your draft report which your peers will review and provide feedback on. You will review a number of your peer's drafts in Part 2 of the assignment. Keep in mind that this is a draft of part of your report, it does not need to be finished, final version of your writing. The purpose is to get feedback before you finish that will help you write a better final version of your report. Your draft excerpt should be around 500 words, but there is not a strict word limit. You should provide enough information that your peers are able to have a good idea of your approach to writing your report.

In your submission for Part 1 of Assignment 3 you should include:

- a draft of approximately 500 words from one or more sections of your report
- a brief explanatory note of where the excerpt fits within your report (e.g. 'This is the introduction' or 'This section outlines my recommendation for what Massey can do' etc.)
- any specific areas that you would like their feedback to focus on (e.g. 'Do the sentences flow?' or 'Have I provided enough detail for my points?')

Part 2 – Feedback on peer drafts

In the Assignment 3 Workshop tool, you will be assigned a number of drafts (usually 2-5) to read and provide peer-review feedback on. The complete peer-review process can be carried out in the Workshop tool on the Stream site. For each draft you have been assigned you should complete the following:

- read the draft, and any additional note that the author provides
- use the criteria in the workshop tool in Stream to provide feedback to your peer on their excerpt draft.
- provide detailed feedback in the Overall feedback box in the workshop tool – if your peer had asked for feedback on specific areas, try and address those concerns

Aspects that you could consider giving feedback on include (but are not limited to):

- Is the title informative, catchy?
- Is the context of the work clear?
- Does the introduction indicate which area of Sustainability at Massey is being investigated?
- Is there a clear aim for the report?
- Have sources been cited properly in the text?
- Is referencing appropriate?
- In the discussion do comments make sense – are they substantiated?
- Is there any repetition in my writing?

Part 3 – Submission of final report and a brief reflection on peer-review

Following Part 2 of the Assignment you will receive feedback from a number of peer-reviewers. As you complete your report you should consider how to use the feedback you have been given, and your experience giving feedback, to improve your quality of your final version. Once you have done this, you will write a brief reflection on your experience of peer-review, and how the process has improved your writing. In this statement you can consider not just the feedback you have been given, but also how your own writing has improved after giving feedback. This statement should be around 100 words, should be included after the reference section of the report, and does not contribute to the 1500 word limit.

For your final submission of Assignment 3 you should upload your completed 1500 (+/- 150) word report that includes all the elements outlined above in the 'Overall Assignment 3 components' section of these instructions.